



When the cost cap rule was brought in, you explained how Williams was behind the leaders in capital expenditure, leaving you short on machinery and software. Two years on, are you better placed?

Yes, I was able to get us USD 20 million more, but by the time we finished the meeting, I think it was all spent. The rules are changing in 2026. You can spend whatever you want on capital expenditure, but you have to pay for the depreciation in your annual operating cap.

The 20 million allowed us to do the short-term bits that were needed, and the remainder will be done in conjunction with those rules.

An interesting topic came up in the press conferences in Saudi Arabia, about the V8 and V10 engines being brought back. What is your take on it? Is that the direction F1 should take?

Let's race with the rules that we've spent three years and hundreds of

millions of dollars developing. After we've been racing for some time, let's take an honest step back. Are we doing the right thing for the sport, for the world?

I love the sound of the old V10s and V8s, but we also have to be honest with ourselves. I think what we are asking for is, let's make sure we have a tone to the engine — a sound that has emotion to it.

Both drivers have mentioned a fundamental issue affecting performance, which is a characteristic of the Williams car in itself. How difficult is it to handle an issue related to the structure?

The important thing is an open, honest discussion about what the real problems are, to make sure that we are not taking them into future cars. It's a problem that has been here for many years.

Though we've made improvements between 2023–24 and 2024–25, it's nowhere near the level

Cut to the chase: Sainz and Albon battle it out at the Saudi Arabian GP.

of the top three teams. We need a bigger change to improve it considerably — and that's what Carlos and Alex are bringing to the party.

F1 requires fast cars to win championships. But how important is the team behind it? How much does the backroom staff influence a team?

Everything is about people and culture. People create your systems, processes and communications. The fast car is just an output from a thousand people working well together. I am not the reason why this team will be successful. My job is just to bring the right people together. If you don't have a set of people pointing the right way, the team will not win a world championship. Every single person matters.